

Xiyu Cao Ph.D. Candidate

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EDUCATION

Department of Communication, University of Macau Taipa, Macau, China
Ph.D candidate in Communication (UM-funded) 2022–2026

- Committee: Todd. L. Sandel (Supervisor), Richard Fitzgerald, Haiyan Wang
- Dissertation: *Unsettled loving: The platformization of female dating practice in contemporary China*
- Research area: Digital intimacy, platform studies, and infrastructure

School of Journalism and Communication, Univeristy of Chinese Academy of Social Sciences Beijing, China
MA. in Journalism 2019–2022

- Thesis: *From Vision to Drosscape: The Infrastructuralization of Facial Recognition Access Control in China*

Department of Agricultural Economic Management, Agricultural University of Hunan Changsha, China
BA. in Agricultural Economic Management 2014–2018

PUBLICATIONS

Refereed Journal Articles

Cao, X., & Sun, P. (2024). “Creating the beta-infrastructure: Facial recognition terminals and social management during and after COVID-19 in China.” *New Media & Society*, 14614448241250033.

Cao, X., & Sun, P. (2025). “Platformed Ritual in Emotions: (Dys)functional Construction of Intimacy in Digital Dating in China.” *Social Media + Society*, 11(1), 20563051251313661.

Academic Services

Peer reviewer for journals

Information Communication & Society

New Media & Society

Conference Presentation

Cao, X. & Sandel, T. (2025). “Personal mourning in ‘home letter’: Contextualization, living-dead communication, and co-constructed afterlife,” will be presented at the National Communication Association 111th Annual Convention.

Cao, X. (2024). “Platformed Ritual in Emotions: (Dys)functional Construction of Intimacy in Digital Dating in China”, presented at the 5th Academic Workshop on Platform Studies.

Cao, X. (2023). “Making Our Idols Mainstream!: Incorporation of Subculture and Fandom Practice in China,” presented at the 73rd Annual International Communication Association Conference.

Book Chapter

Sun, P., & Cao, X. (2024). "Review on Woman studies and Media studies (2016-2020)"
In Du, J., & Mi, R., Eds. *Yearbook of Women's Studies in China (2016–2020)*. Beijing:
Social Sciences Academic Press.

AWARDS AND HONORS

Top Paper Award, 2025, NCA, Language and Social Interaction Division

Awarded Outstanding Thesis, 2022, University of Chinese Academy of Social Sciences

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Macau

Undergraduate Courses

Teaching Assistant and Session Instructor

- Media and Society (2022 Fall, 2023-001 Fall)
- Intercultural Communication (2023 Spring, 2024-001 and 2024-002 Spring)

Graduate Courses

Teaching Assistant and Tutor

- Academic Writing and Research (2022 Fall)
- Communication Research (2023 Spring)
- Academic Writing and Scholarship (2024 Fall, 2025-001 and 2025-002 Fall)
- Special Topics on Communication Research (2025 Spring)

RESEARCH METHODS AND SKILLS

Research method: Fieldwork, interviews, digital ethnography, multimodal discourse analysis, and narrative analysis.

Skills: Experienced in Python, SPSS, web design, and video editing.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Association of Internet Researchers, International Communication Association, International Chinese Communication Association, National Communication Association